

Worship of God should not Be confined to temples

We have heard of the Sanskrit phrase from our ancient texts, Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam: the world is one family. Through our growing years, we are taught to avoid selfish **pursuits** and prioritise our families' **well-being**. However, **thinking** beyond our families **can** become a struggle.

Swami Vivekananda says, "Like the **caterpillar** that takes the thread from its own mouth and builds its **cocoon** and at last finds itself caught inside the cocoon, we have bound ourselves by our actions."

We believe we are all separate, cutting ourselves from our **universal** identity. Unaware of the universal energy that connects us all, we **immerse** ourselves **in** identifying with our thoughts, identity, and status, creating a bond with the body-mind complex. We create a cocoon of self-interest around our lives through our actions. The **way out** of this limited life **lies** in Swami Vivekananda's inspiring call of **expansion** and **oneness**. He says, "Expansion is Life. **Contraction** is death. The more unselfish we become, the more peace **pours** into us. When we are selfish, we **contract**, bringing **misery** into our lives."

Swami Vivekananda says each soul is potentially **divine**. The goal is to **manifest** this **divinity**. According to him, worship of God should not be **confined to** churches and temples. **The starting point** of Swamiji's teaching **was** that we are all divine, and there is the same divinity in everyone.

Ann Myren, one of his Western followers, **says**: "Divinity of man for him was a continuous spiritual experience. His **consciousness** had transformed."

When this idea that we are all one and this individual identity is an **illusion permeates** our being, humanistic **impulses** emerge from our personality. We can break free from our likes and dislikes, **devastating jealousies** and **arrogance of accomplishments**. From an **elevated** awareness comes **tremendous** respect for human life and relationships. It transforms our motivations and actions.

Swami Vivekananda says, "Everything that is strong, good, and powerful in human nature is the outcome of that divinity. To every man, this is taught: Thou art one with this Universal Being, and, as such every soul that exists is your soul, and every body that exists is your body; and in hurting anyone, you hurt yourself, in loving anyone, you love yourself."

In a world filled with **discord**, this **uplifting** message offers much-needed guidance to balance our pursuits. Swami Vivekananda has **breathed new vitality into** this grand ideal realised by our ancient rishis. Along with the mantra of success, this universal ideal should also be introduced to every young mind. So that, as they grow, they can break free from their selfish interests and become worthy world citizens with expanded hearts. With Vivekananda's strength **inducing** message – "Arise, awake and stop not till the goal is reached" – **emblazoned** in our hearts if we can manifest even a little of this oneness in our lives, it will do **wonders** to human relationships. **Spontaneity** will flow from our hearts.

Feelings for others will **magnify**. **Gradually**, we can transform the world into one family, truly living the ideal of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

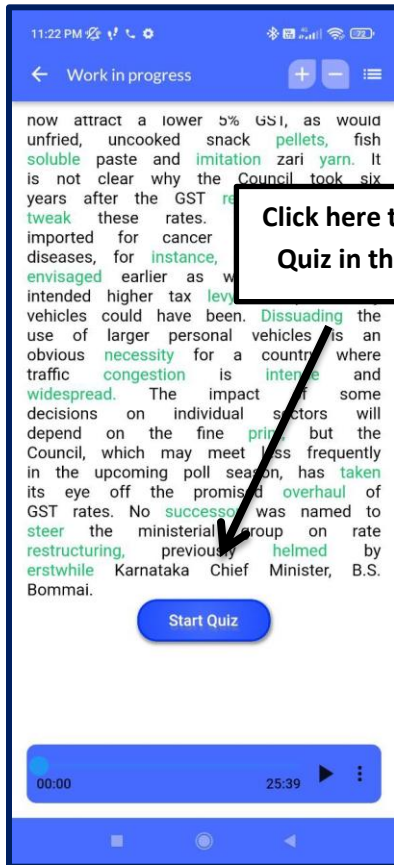
1. **Pursuit** (noun) – Endeavor, quest, striving, chase लक्ष्य या खोज
2. **Well-being** (noun) – Welfare, health, happiness, comfort भलाई
3. **Caterpillar** (noun) – Larva of a butterfly or moth, wormlike insect, creeping insect इल्ली
4. **Cocoon** (noun) – Protective case, chrysalis, covering in which a caterpillar transforms कच्चे रेशम का कोवा
5. **Universal** (adjective) – All-encompassing, worldwide, global, collective सार्वभौमिक
6. **Immerse** (in) (verb) – Submerge, absorb, engross, involve शामिल होना
7. **Way out** (noun) – Escape, solution, path to freedom, exit समाधान
8. **Lie** (verb) – Reside, exist, be found, be located होना
9. **Expansion** (noun) – Growth, increase, enlargement, extension विस्तार
10. **Oneness** (noun) – Unity, unity of being, singularity, non-duality एकत्व
11. **Contraction** (noun) – Reduction, shrinking, narrowing, decrease सिकुड़ना
12. **Pour** (verb) – Flow, stream, surge, gush उंडेलना
13. **Contract** (verb) – Shrink, diminish, reduce, narrow सिकुड़ जाना
14. **Misery** (noun) – Distress, suffering, anguish, unhappiness कष्ट
15. **Divine** (adjective) – Godly, sacred, holy, celestial दैवीय
16. **Manifest** (verb) – Reveal, demonstrate, display, show स्पष्ट होना/दिखाना
17. **Divinity** (noun) – Godhood, sacredness, holiness, spiritual essence दिव्यता
18. **Confine** (to) (verb) – Restrict, limit, enclose, bound सीमित करना
19. **Consciousness** (noun) – Awareness, mindfulness, perception, cognizance चेतना
20. **Illusion** (noun) – Mirage, false impression, misconception, hallucination भ्रम
21. **Permeate** (verb) – Spread throughout, fill, penetrate, infiltrate व्याप्त होना
22. **Impulse** (noun) – Urge, instinct, drive, sudden desire प्रेरणा
23. **Devastating** (adjective) – Destructive, ruinous, catastrophic, overwhelming विनाशकारी
24. **Jealousy** (noun) – Envy, covetousness, resentment, bitterness ईर्ष्या

25. **Arrogance** (noun) – Pride, haughtiness, conceit, hubris अहंकार
26. **Accomplishment** (noun) – Achievement, success, attainment, feat उपलब्धि
27. **Elevated** (adjective) – Uplifted, raised, inspired, lofty ऊँचा/उन्नत
28. **Tremendous** (adjective) – Huge, enormous, immense, excellent बहुत बड़ा/अत्यधिक
29. **Discord** (noun) – Conflict, disagreement, disharmony, strife कलह
30. **Uplifting** (adjective) – Inspiring, heartening, encouraging, elevating उत्साहवर्द्धक
31. **Breathe** (verb) – Inhale/exhale, respire, draw air साँस लेना
32. **Vitality** (noun) – Energy, liveliness, vigor, dynamism जीवंतता
33. **Inducing** (adjective) – Causing, triggering, prompting, bringing about उत्प्रेरित करने वाला
34. **Emblazon** (verb) – Adorn, decorate, inscribe, display उजागर करना
35. **Wonder** (verb) – Be curious, question, ponder, be amazed आश्चर्य करना
36. **Spontaneity** (noun) – Unplannedness, impulsiveness, naturalness, freedom स्वाभाविकता
37. **Magnify** (verb) – Enlarge, increase, enhance, amplify बढ़ाना
38. **Gradually** (adverb) – Slowly, progressively, step by step, incrementally धीरे-धीरे

Summary of the Editorial

1. **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam:** The ancient ideal of "*the world is one family*" urges individuals to rise above selfish pursuits and think universally.
2. **Self-Interest Cocoon:** Swami Vivekananda likens self-centeredness to a caterpillar building a cocoon, trapping itself through its actions.
3. **Universal Identity:** Focusing solely on personal identity and status detaches us from the universal energy that connects all beings.
4. **Expansion vs. Contraction:** Vivekananda emphasizes that unselfishness leads to peace and expansion of life, while selfishness results in misery and contraction.
5. **Divinity in Everyone:** Each soul is divine, and recognizing this divinity should extend beyond temples and churches to encompass all of life.
6. **Transformative Consciousness:** Vivekananda's teachings inspire individuals to embrace the idea of oneness, transcending likes, dislikes, jealousy, and arrogance.
7. **Respect for Humanity:** Elevated awareness brings respect for human life and relationships, transforming motivations and actions.
8. **Unity of Being:** According to Vivekananda, harming others is akin to harming oneself, and loving others equates to loving oneself, as we are all one with the Universal Being.
9. **Guidance in Discord:** In a world of conflict, Vivekananda's message offers a roadmap to balance personal and universal goals.
10. **Youth Education:** Instilling these ideals in young minds can encourage them to transcend selfishness and grow into compassionate global citizens.
11. **Call to Action:** Vivekananda's mantra, "*Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached,*" motivates individuals to manifest oneness and purpose in their lives.
12. **Transformation Through Oneness:** Realizing the interconnectedness of all beings can improve human relationships and magnify feelings of empathy.
13. **Universal Family:** By embracing the principle of oneness, humanity can embody the ideal of *Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam*, transforming the world into one harmonious family.
14. **Spiritual Experience:** Vivekananda's teachings, rooted in ancient wisdom, encourage the continuous spiritual realization of the divinity within all.
15. **Practical Impact:** Introducing these teachings into daily life can foster a spontaneous, heartfelt connection with others, promoting universal peace and unity.

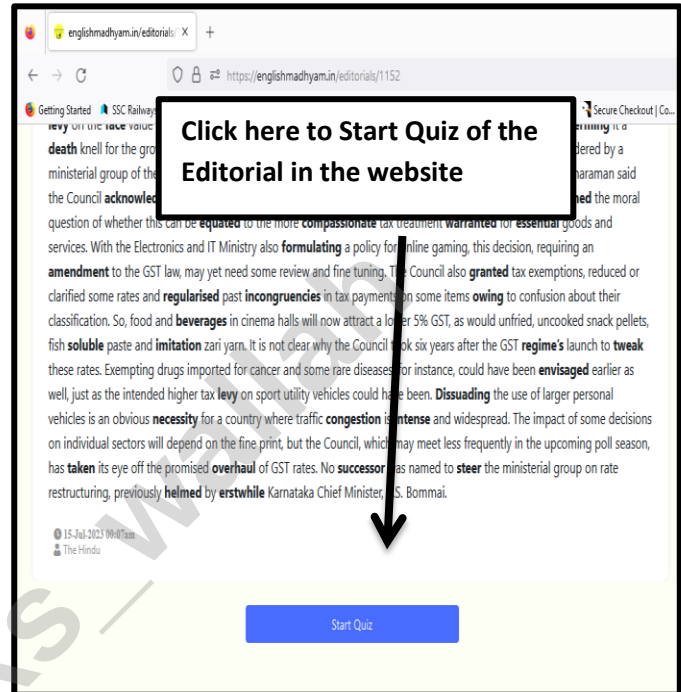
Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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